

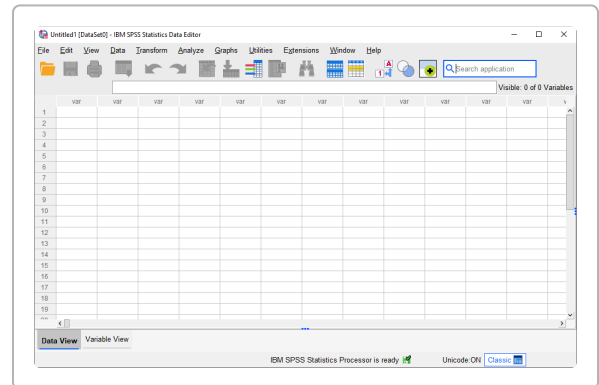
Data View

Warning

Remember to save often when entering data!!

The image shows the **Data View** of the SPSS editor.

- Switch between **Data View** and **Variable View** with the tabs at the lower left of the screen
- Each *row* holds the data from a participant or “case”
- Each *column* holds the data for a variable
- Data can be loaded from an existing `.sav` file using “Open an Existing File”
- Or data can be manually entered or copied into the cells of the **Data View** after selecting “New Dataset”



Data for This Example

The initial form of most datasets is a listing of variable values for each participant. Usually, each row is a different participant, with a column for each variable.

Below are the data for 11 participants. Each “participant” is a different Superman media portrayal. Researchers recorded information about 8 variables (each column represents info for a different variable).

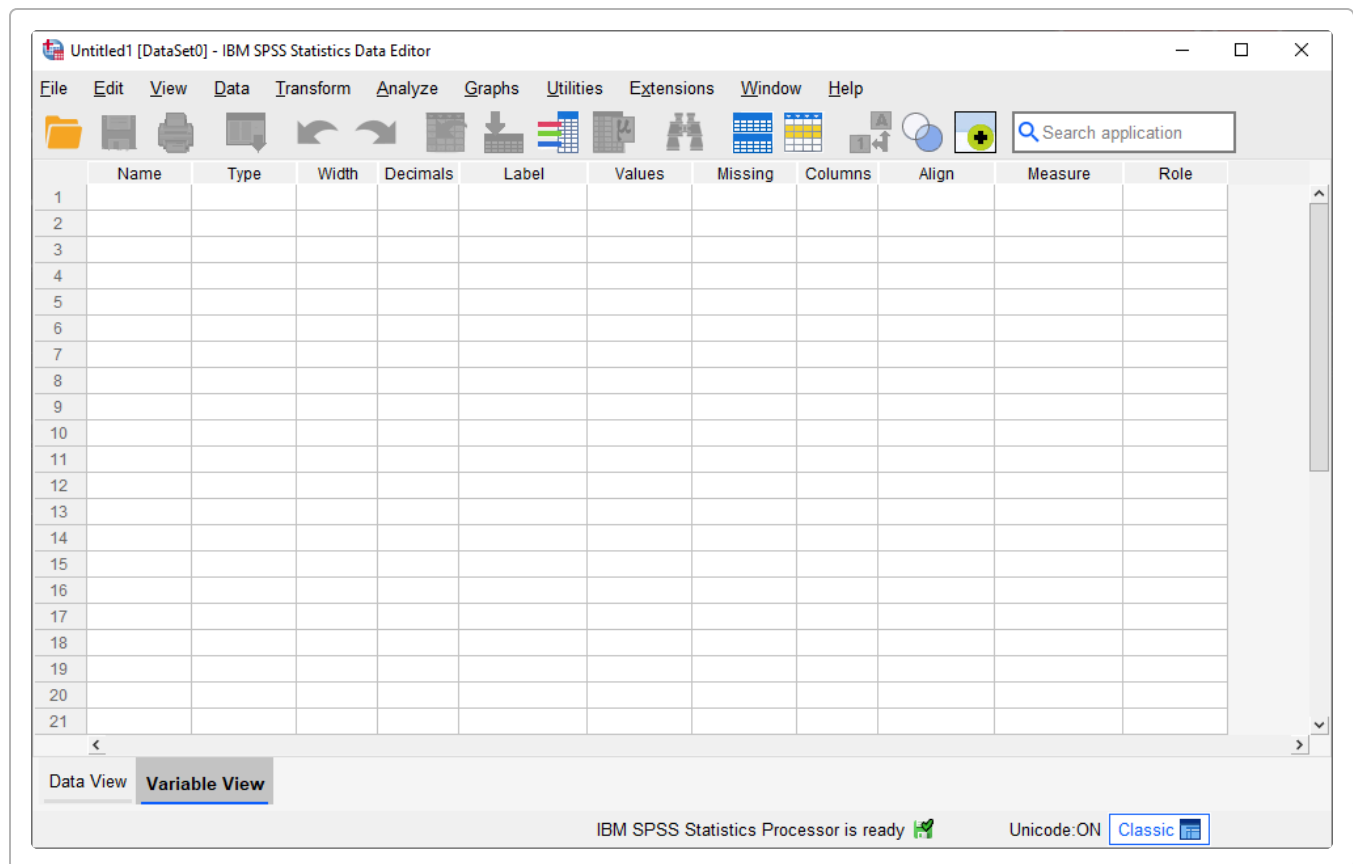
Columns in the data table

1. **Participant number:** [`interval scale`] usually consecutive numbers starting with 1 or 001 or some similar numbering system
2. **Type of media:** [`categorical`] “1” = Film, “2” = TV Show, “3” = Serial. Note: the variable value “codes” for something else. We do not interpret it as an inherently meaningful number
3. **Year of release:** [`ratio scale`] calendar year
4. **Height of Clark Kent/Superman actor:** [`ratio scale`] in inches (2 decimals), “-99” means height not available
5. **Height of Lois Lane actor:** [`ratio scale`] in inches (2 decimals), “-99” means height not available
6. **Age of Clark Kent/Superman actor:** [`ratio scale`] in years (2 decimals), “-99” means height not available
7. **Age of Lois Lane actor:** [`ratio scale`] in years (2 decimals), “-99” means height not available
8. **Rotten Tomatoes critics score:** [`ratio scale`] using a 0–100 scale, “-99” means score not available
9. **Rotten Tomatoes audience score:** [`ratio scale`] using a 0–100% scale, “-99” means score not available

The Variable View

Tip

Each row holds the information about one variable. Each column holds a different *type* of information about that variable.



Naming Variables

Click a cell under the Name column and type in the name you want to assign to that variable.

Tip

It is good practice to label all of your variables so you do not later forget what the variable names represent.

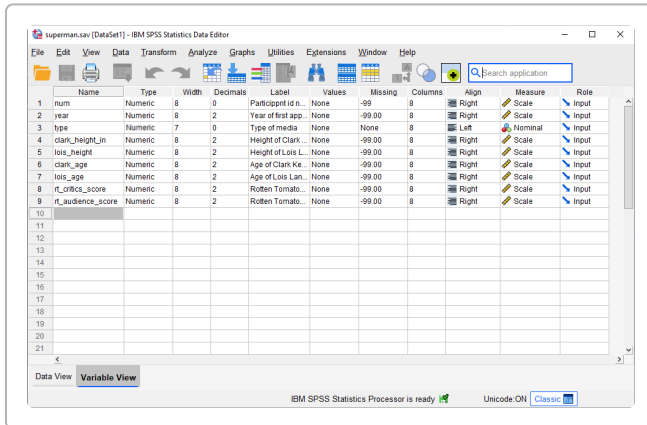
- Names can be very long, a mix of letters and numbers, as well as “-” and “_”. The first character must be a letter.
- Outputs only show about the first 25 characters of a name, so making the unique part come first will make reading outputs easier.
- Entering a variable name causes default values to appear in the other columns — we will want to change these later.

Important

Don’t forget to specify variable details — some make analyses and outputs easier to read, others tell SPSS how to treat the data.

Variable Labels

- Clicking a cell in the “Label” column allows you to type up to 256 characters describing the variable (what that variable name represents)
- For example, the label for `type` describes it as “Type of media”.



Type, Width, & Decimals

You can usually use the default values for these.

- Type:** Numeric works for both qualitative and quantitative data. We will not use the other types in this class.
- Width:** Maximum number of digits in a number. Make sure the width is equal to, or larger than, the highest value for that variable.
- Decimals:** Number of places after the decimal. For integers, this can be zero. Otherwise, it loosely relates to the “precision” of the variable’s measurement.

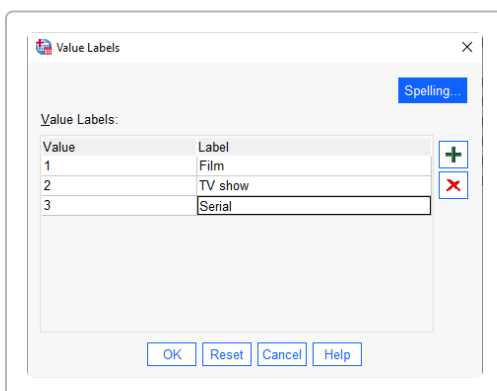
Value Labels

Important

Only categorical/qualitative variables need value labels. Quantitative variables like `clark_age` or `year` do not.

For categorical variables, the values in the data view “code” for something else. The “Values” column tells SPSS what those values represent.

- Click a cell under “Values”, then click the button that appears
- Enter each value and its label one at a time. For example, for `type`: 1 = Film, 2 = TV Show, 3 = Serial
- Click Add, then repeat for each value and label pair. To return, Click OK.



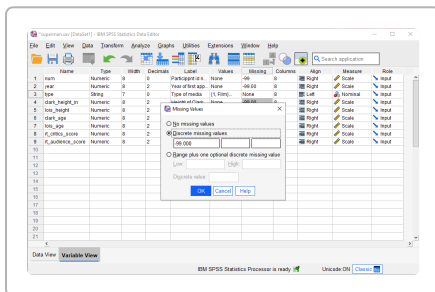
Note

Note how the variable descriptions above relate to the variable names used in the “Name” column of the **Variable View**.

Missing Values

There are two types of missing values in SPSS:

- **System missing:** When a cell is left blank, SPSS marks it with a period (.). This is called a “system missing” value.
- **User missing:** When a specific code (like –99) is used to indicate that data are not available. We need to tell SPSS to ignore these values, otherwise it will treat –99 as an actual measurement!

**Setting User Missing Values**

In this dataset, “–99” is used to indicate that a value is not available. You must tell SPSS to treat –99 as a missing value:

1. In **Variable View**, click the cell under “Missing” for the variable you want to define
2. Click the three-dot button that appears to open the Missing Values window
3. Select “Discrete missing values” and enter up to 3 different missing value codes (e.g., –99)
4. Click OK to save
5. Repeat for each variable that uses this convention

